

Yulin Shao

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Research Interests

Causal inference and clinical trials methodology; uncertainty quantification and Bayesian methods; machine learning with statistical foundations, including large language models. Broadly interested in developing rigorous statistical methods at the intersection of theory and applied problems in data-driven sciences.

Education

Purdue University

Ph.D. in Statistics

West Lafayette, IN

Sep. 2026 – Present

University of Michigan, Ann Arbor

M.S. in Biostatistics

Ann Arbor, MI

Sep. 2024 – May 2026

- GPA: 4.2/4.3 (Top 3%; A+ = 4.30)

University of Michigan, Ann Arbor

B.S. in Honors Mathematics & Data Science

Ann Arbor, MI

Sep. 2022 – May 2024

Macalester College (*Transferred to University of Michigan*)

Honors Mathematics & Computer Science

St. Paul, MN

Sep. 2020 – May 2022

- GPA: 4.0/4.0 (Top 1%)

Publications & Manuscripts

- **Yulin Shao**, Liangbo Lyu, Menggang Yu, & Bingkai Wang (2026). How should covariates be handled in randomized trials? Empirical evidence from 50 trials and recommendations for practice. *Journal of Clinical Epidemiology*, 112374.
doi:10.1016/j.jclinepi.2026.112374 arXiv:2602.00434

Research Experience

University of Michigan, Ann Arbor

Graduate Research Assistant / *Supervisor: Prof. Bingkai Wang*

Ann Arbor, MI

May 2025 – May 2026

Empirical Study of Statistical Methods for Randomized Clinical Trials

- Curated and standardized 50 real-world RCTs from public repositories (29,094 participants; 574 treatment-outcome comparisons) with unified R pipelines for missing-data imputation, outcome filtering, and covariate standardization.
- Implemented and evaluated 18 statistical methods combining 6 modeling approaches (ANCOVA, AN-HECOVA, IPW, logistic g-computation, TMLE, DML) with 3 covariate-selection strategies; showed ANCOVA achieves 17% average variance reduction while ML methods provide no empirical advantage in finite samples.
- Established evidence-based guidelines for covariate adjustment; published all datasets and reproducible code on GitHub to support clinical-trials methodology research.

University of Michigan, Ann Arbor

Graduate Research Assistant / *Supervisor: Dr. Wen Ye*

Ann Arbor, MI

Jan. 2025 – May 2025

Development of Diabetic Kidney Disease Sub-Model within the Michigan Diabetes Model

- Processed 160,000+ longitudinal observations from 1,948 DPPOS Phase 3 patients (up to 25+ years of follow-up) tracking 15+ clinical parameters (eGFR, UACR, A1C, etc.) in R.

- Built and validated a DKD progression sub-model using competing-risks analysis for CKD and mortality and Kaplan-Meier estimators, enabling simulation of 7 major clinical outcomes for type-2 diabetes patients.
- Authored comprehensive data dictionaries for longitudinal DPP/DPPOS datasets, contributing to a cost-effectiveness framework for healthcare policy decisions.

University of Michigan, Ann Arbor

Ann Arbor, MI

Undergraduate Research Assistant / *Supervisor: Prof. Colin Fogarty*

Apr. 2023 – Dec. 2023

Development of a Prepivoted Permutation Test R Package

- Implemented Gaussian and bootstrap prepivoting approaches into a production-ready R package for hypothesis tests exact under equality of distributions and asymptotically valid for equality of parameters.
- Engineered high-performance parallel infrastructure via Rcpp to handle nested resampling (999 permutations $\times$ 200–500 bootstrap draws), achieving substantial speedup for Hotelling's T^2 , ANOVA F -statistics, and maximum absolute t -statistics.
- Created extensive documentation and unit tests to ensure reproducibility and facilitate adoption.

Teaching Experience

Purdue University

West Lafayette, IN

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Statistics

Aug. 2026 – Present

University of Michigan, Ann Arbor

Ann Arbor, MI

Graduate Student Instructor (GSI), Department of Biostatistics

Fall 2025

- BIOSTAT 600: Introduction to Biostatistics; BIOSTAT 625: Computing with Big Data

University of Michigan, Ann Arbor

Ann Arbor, MI

Teaching Assistant, Department of Mathematics

Fall 2023

- MATH 451: Advanced Calculus

Macalester College

St. Paul, MN

Teaching Assistant, Department of MSCS

Fall 2021, Winter 2022

- COMP 123: Core Concepts in Computer Science

Service

Curriculum Committee Member

Fall 2025 – Winter 2026

Department of Biostatistics, University of Michigan

Awards & Honors

University Honors, University of Michigan

2023

Finalist Award (Top 1%), Mathematical Contest in Modeling 2022

2022

Turck Honors Scholarship, Macalester College

2020–2022

Dean's List, Macalester College

2020–2022